

transitions, and effects. But the real killer in this tool is the AutoMovie feature, which takes the raw footage you feed it and creates an edited movie without any input from the user - ideal for those who are too lazy to edit their home videos, or for those last minute video presentations.

The user interface is similar to that of any other non-linear editing suite. It consists of a collections section where the video you imported for editing is stored as clips, a storyboard, and a timeline view that can be toggled. The preview screen also helps keep track of the editing you're doing.

WMM2 supports video captured both in digital and analogue format. 'Capture Video' in the tool's taskbar guides you through the entire video transfer process. We'd recommend, however, that you transfer your data onto the computer separately and compress it into one of the easily manipulated formats, such as MPEG. If you choose the default selection - "Best quality for playback on my computer" - the captured video will be stored as a WMV 9 video, which is a good compression format but has limited playback options, as most codec packs and players are yet to support this format.

When you capture or import a video, WMM2 creates a collection, which is essentially the raw footage. However, you can add other audio, video and images to this. Hence the term "Collection." Collection clips, naturally, are displayed in the centre "Collections" view. To start a project, you drag one or more of the clips to the storyboard or timeline pane. In 'Timeline' view, separate tracks for video, transitions, audio, audio/music, and title overlay give you a nice, graphical overview of the project. Once here, you can play around with effects such as video transitions, add titles or credits, or just sit back and let AutoMovie make your movie for you. AutoMovie can create a highlights movie with clean and simple cuts, fades, and titles. The feature also offers other exciting choices, such as a music video option, where you can select the background music and let the wizard edit the video to the length of the music, and add video transitions that go with the music.